OQL CHEATSHEET

OpenAlex query language • Standalone examples: adapt the terms, fields, and IDs.

TASK	KEYWORD	EXAMPLE
START A QUERY		
Find works	get works	`get works about coral`
Find people	get authors	`get authors with an h-index above 50`
Find institutions	get institutions	`get institutions in [Austria](AT)`
Find journals	get journals	`get journals where publisher is [Elsevier](P4310320990)`
Count a set	get the count of	`get the count of works about coral`
TEXT AND SEMANTIC SEARCH		
Search a subject	about	`get works about coral`
Search titles	with ... in the title	`get works with coral in the title`
Search abstracts	with ... in the abstract	`get works with coral in the abstract`
Title or abstract	in the title or abstract	`get works with coral in the title or abstract`
Include full text	in the full text	`get works with coral in the full text`
Exact phrase	"..."	`get works about "ocean heat"`
Stemmed phrase	stemmed "..."	`get works with (stemmed "genome editing") in the title`
Require both terms	AND	`get works about (coral AND reef)`
Accept either term	OR	`get works about (coral OR seagrass)`
Exclude a term	NOT	`get works about (coral NOT aquarium)`
Word prefix / one character	* / ?	`get works with (coral* OR wom?n) in the title`
Nearby terms	within ... words of each other	`get works with ("coral" and "reef" within 3 words of each other) in the title`
Semantic similarity (vector search)	is similar to	`get works where abstract is similar to ("coastal ecosystem restoration")`
Affiliation text	raw affiliation has	`get works where raw affiliation has (London AND hospital)`
Published author name	byline has	`get works where byline has "jane smith"`
DATES, RECORD TYPE, AND ACCESS		
One publication year	from	`get works from 2022 about coral`
A year onward	since	`get works since 2022 about coral`
Earlier than a year	before	`get works before 2022 about coral`
Inclusive year interval	from ...–...	`get works from 2020–2023 about coral`
Inclusive date interval	from ... through ...	`get works from 2020-01-01 through 2023-12-31 about coral`
Restrict record type	articles / reviews / books / ...	`get reviews about coral`
Access status	open access / closed access	`get open access works about coral`
Retraction status	retracted / non-retracted	`get non-retracted works about coral`
Highly cited works	top 1% cited / top 10% cited	`get top 1% cited works about coral`
FIELD CONDITIONS		
Equal a value	where ... is	`get works where language is [English](en)`
Exclude a value	is not	`get works where type is not [review](review)`
Greater / at least	is above / is at least	`get works where citation count is at least 20`
Less / at most	is below / is at most	`get works where citation count is below 20`

TASK	KEYWORD	EXAMPLE
FIELD CONDITIONS (cont.)		
Missing / present value	is unknown / is not unknown	`get works where language is unknown`
Field-level text search	has	`get works where title has (coral OR reef)`
Require / exclude a property	it has / it doesn't have	`get works where it has a DOI and it doesn't have an abstract`
Combine conditions	and / or / not / (...)	`get works where language is [English](en) and citation count is above 20`
Choose among values	is (... or ...)	`get works where type is ([article](article) or [review](review))`
ENTITIES, IDENTIFIERS, AND RELATIONS		
Institution affiliation	from [name](ID)	`get works from [MIT](I63966007) about coral`
An author	author is [name](ID)	`get works where author is [Priem](A5023888391)`
Venue	in [name](ID)	`get works in [Nature](S137773608)`
Topic / field / SDG	in the topic / in the field / in SDG	`get works in the field [Computer Science](17)`
Funder / publisher	funded by / published by	`get works funded by [NIH](F4320332161)`
Known work IDs	id is (... or ...)	`get works where id is (W2741809807 or W2100837269)`
Works citing a paper	citing	`get works citing [paper](W2741809807)`
A paper's references	cited by	`get works cited by [paper](W2741809807)`
Related works	it's related to	`get works where it's related to ([paper](W2741809807))`
A saved collection	in the collection	`get works in the collection [papers](col_8yWKmRNyEr)`
A query-defined set	is in the set	`get works where institution is in the set (institutions where country is [Kenya](KE))`
ORDERING — AFTER THE FINAL COMMA		
Citations	most cited first / least cited first	`get works about coral, most cited first`
Publication date	newest first / oldest first	`get works about coral, newest first`
Relevance	best matches first	`get works about coral, best matches first`
Citation impact	highest FWCI first / lowest FWCI first	`get works about coral, highest FWCI first`
Text order	alphabetical by ... / reverse alphabetical by ...	`get works about coral, alphabetical by title`
Numeric order	highest ... first / lowest ... first	`get authors with an h-index above 50, highest h-index first`
GROUPS AND MEASURES		
Split results into groups	by	`get the count of works about coral by year`
Two splits	by ... and ...	`get the count of works about coral by year and open access status`
Average / median	mean / median	`get the mean FWCI and median FWCI of works about coral by year`
Total a measure	sum of	`get the sum of citations to works about coral by year`
Percent satisfying a flag	percent	`get the percent open access of works about coral by year`

TASK	KEYWORD	EXAMPLE
GROUPS AND MEASURES (cont.)		
Share of the set	share	`get the count and share of works about coral by country`
Select named groups	by ... in (...)	`get the count of works about coral by country in ([United States](US), [China](CN))`
Exclude a group	except	`get the count of works about coral by country except [Kenya](KE)`
Keep groups above a count	Only ... with at least ...	`get the count of works about coral by author. Only authors with at least 20 works about coral.`
Add group-record fields	Show	`get the count of works about coral by author. Show h-index.`
ADVANCED STEPS — SEPARATE WITH SEMICOLONS		
Run successive steps	; then, ... ; finally, ...	`get works where published in 2020; then, sample 50 of those works; finally, summarize using count`
Reproducible sample	sample ... with seed	`get works where published in 2020; then, sample 50 of those works with seed 42`
Compare conditions	compare ... versus ... using	`get works where published since 2015; then, compare country [India](IN) versus country is not [India](IN) using count`
Three splits	group those works by ...	`get works where title has coral; then, group those works by continent, institution type, and year; finally, summarize using count`
Bins with chosen boundaries	bins at	`get works where title has coral; then, group those works into citation count bins at (1, 10, 100); finally, summarize using count`
Bins with a fixed width	bins of	`get works where title has coral; then, group those works into FWCI bins of 0.5; finally, summarize using count`
Min / max	summarize using min / max	`get works where title has coral; then, summarize using min FWCI and max FWCI`
Follow authors, then their works	get each ... / get all ...	`get works where title has coral; then, get each author of those works; then, get all that author's works; finally, summarize each author using count`
Change corpus	(all corpora) / (expansion corpus)	`get works (all corpora) where title has coral`

Text operators: AND / OR / NOT. Conditions: and / or / not. Entity links: [label](ID); the ID identifies the entity.

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